1

LESSON 1 · ANY LEVEL

Matariki: the Māori New Year

Te Reo Māori · Relief lessons

WHS

Waiheke High School · Te Reo Māori · Relief lessons · Lesson 1 · 1

START

Matariki

Matariki

RELIEF LESSONS · ARA 1–3

START

WHAT WE ARE LEARNING

We are learning about Matariki, the Māori New Year, and the stars of the Matariki cluster.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- I can explain what Matariki is and when it happens.
- I can name some stars of Matariki and what each is connected to.
- I can write a Matariki wish (Ara 2 and 3 in te reo).

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What is Matariki?

- A cluster of stars that rises before dawn in mid-winter (June or July).
- It marks **te tau hou Māori**, the Māori New Year.
- A public holiday in Aotearoa since 2022.
- Remember the past · celebrate the present · plan for the future.

LEARN

Ngā whetū o Matariki · the nine stars

Matariki
health and wellbeing

Pōhutukawa
those who have died

Tupuānuku
food grown in the ground

Tupuārangi
food from trees and birds

Waitī
fresh water and its food

Waitā
the ocean and its food

Waipunarangi
rain

Ururangi
the winds

Hiwa-i-te-rangi
wishes for the year ahead

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Three ways to celebrate

Remember

- Matariki Hunga Nui
- Remember those who have died since last Matariki.

Celebrate

- Matariki Ahunga Nui
- Share kai with whānau and friends.

Look ahead

- Matariki Manako Nui
- Make wishes and plans for the new year.

LEARN

Kupu hou · new words

whetū
star

tau hou
new year

rangi
sky

kai
food

wai
water

hau
wind

ua
rain

wawata
wish; hope

DO

Your task

Worksheet Everyone: Parts A and B.

Worksheet Then your Ara section (Ara 1, 2 or 3).

Book Finished? Draw the Matariki cluster and label three stars.

FINISH

↻ REVIEW

Hiwa-i-te-rangi · make a wish

- Share one Matariki wish with the person next to you.
- Which star do you think is most important? Why?